

COMPLETE COMPANY POLICY HANDBOOK

For an Indian Private Limited Company – HR, Employee, Workplace, IT, Operational & Compliance Policies

Purpose: This handbook is a structured starting framework for building an organization's policy library. Each policy should be converted into a detailed company-specific document after deciding the company's employee strength, state/location, industry, working model, benefits and applicable laws.

Important legal note: This is not legal advice and does not replace applicable law, employment contracts, statutory rules or professional legal review. Some policies are mandatory only when specific legal thresholds or conditions apply.

1. Employment & General Workplace Policies

Employment & Appointment Policy

Defines employment terms, designation, compensation, probation, working hours, notice period and other employment conditions.

Probation & Confirmation Policy

Defines probation duration, review process, extension and confirmation requirements.

Working Hours & Attendance Policy

Covers work timings, attendance, punctuality, weekly offs, late coming and attendance regularization.

Remote / Hybrid Work Policy

Defines eligibility, approvals, availability, productivity, security and equipment requirements for remote work.

Dress Code & Workplace Etiquette

Sets expectations for professional appearance, workplace conduct and respectful communication.

2. Leave & Holiday Policies

Leave Policy

Defines available leave categories, eligibility, approval workflow, documentation and leave balance rules.

Sick Leave Policy

Covers illness-related absence, notification and medical documentation where applicable.

Earned / Privilege Leave Policy

Defines accrual, application, carry-forward and encashment rules.

Maternity / Statutory Leave Policy

Covers applicable statutory leave and benefits.

Holiday Policy

Defines company holidays, national holidays and applicable regional holidays.

Leave Without Pay Policy

Defines circumstances and approval process for unpaid leave.

3. Recruitment & Onboarding Policies

Manpower Requisition Policy

Defines position creation, business justification, budget approval and hiring authorization.

Recruitment & Selection Policy

Covers sourcing, screening, interviews, selection, compensation approval and offer process.

Employee Referral Policy

Defines referral eligibility, process and referral incentive conditions.

Background Verification Policy

Defines reference/background verification requirements and handling of adverse findings.

Internship Policy

Covers internship duration, stipend, supervision, evaluation, conversion and exit.

Onboarding & Induction Policy

Defines joining documentation, induction, IT access, assets, payroll setup and orientation.

4. Compensation & Benefits Policies

Compensation & Salary Policy

Defines salary structure, pay dates, revisions and confidentiality.

Payroll Policy

Covers payroll processing, deductions, payslips, statutory deductions and payroll records.

Variable Pay / Incentive Policy

Defines eligibility, targets, calculation, approvals and payout conditions.

Bonus Policy

Covers applicable statutory or company bonus arrangements.

Travel & Expense Policy

Defines business travel, accommodation, meals, local conveyance, approvals and reimbursement.

Employee Benefits Policy

Covers applicable insurance, wellness and other employee benefits.

ESOP / Equity Policy

Where applicable, defines grant, vesting, exercise and related terms; plan documents should govern.

5. Performance & Career Policies

Performance Management System (PMS) Policy

Defines goal setting, review cycles, self-assessment, manager review, ratings and finalization.

Goal & KPI Policy

Defines measurable goals, ownership, review and changes during the performance cycle.

Promotion Policy

Defines eligibility, performance criteria, approvals and effective dates.

Internal Transfer / Job Posting Policy

Defines movement between teams/roles and internal opportunities.

Learning & Development Policy

Covers training, certifications, development plans and learning reimbursement where offered.

Succession Planning Policy

Defines identification and development of critical talent and roles.

6. Employee Conduct & Ethics Policies

Code of Conduct

Sets standards for integrity, professionalism, respect, confidentiality and responsible use of company resources.

Anti-Harassment & POSH Policy

Defines prevention, reporting and redressal of sexual harassment and other prohibited workplace conduct, as applicable.

Equal Opportunity / Anti-Discrimination Policy

Promotes fair employment practices and prohibits unlawful discrimination.

Conflict of Interest Policy

Covers outside employment, competing interests, related-party situations and disclosures.

Gifts & Hospitality Policy

Defines acceptable gifts, entertainment and business courtesies.

Whistleblower / Speak-Up Policy

Provides a channel for reporting serious misconduct, fraud or unethical behaviour.

Grievance Redressal Policy

Defines how employees can raise workplace concerns and the escalation/investigation process.

Disciplinary & Misconduct Policy

Defines investigation, employee response, documentation and proportionate disciplinary action.

7. IT, Information Security & Data Policies

Information Security Policy

Defines protection of company information, systems, credentials and business data.

Acceptable Use Policy

Covers appropriate use of laptops, internet, email, software and company systems.

Password & Access Management Policy

Defines password standards, MFA where applicable, access approvals and access removal.

Data Privacy / Personal Data Policy

Defines collection, use, access, retention, sharing and protection of personal data as applicable.

Social Media Policy

Defines responsible use of social media and protection of confidential company information.

BYOD Policy

Where permitted, defines security requirements for personal devices used for work.

Company Asset Policy

Covers allocation, use, maintenance, return and loss/damage of company assets.

Joiner-Mover-Leaver Access Policy

Defines creation, modification and revocation of employee system access.

8. Employee Welfare & Workplace Safety

Workplace Health & Safety Policy

Defines general workplace safety responsibilities and incident reporting.

Employee Well-being Policy

Covers workplace well-being initiatives and support programs where offered.

Emergency & Incident Response Policy

Defines procedures for fire, evacuation, security incidents and other emergencies.

Substance Abuse Policy

Defines prohibited use of alcohol/drugs in the workplace or while representing the company, subject to applicable law.

9. Business & Operational Policies

Delegation of Authority / Approval Matrix

Defines who can approve hiring, expenses, purchases, contracts and other business decisions.

Procurement Policy

Defines vendor selection, quotations, approvals, purchase orders and conflict controls.

Vendor Management Policy

Covers onboarding, due diligence, contracts, performance and offboarding of vendors.

Records Retention Policy

Defines retention, access, archival and secure disposal of company records.

Business Travel Policy

Defines authorization, travel class, accommodation and expense rules.

10. Exit & Separation Policies

Resignation & Separation Policy

Defines resignation submission, acceptance, notice period and separation workflow.

Notice Period Policy

Defines notice obligations, early release, handover and applicable buyout provisions.

Absconding / Unauthorized Absence Policy

Defines escalation and disciplinary process for prolonged unauthorized absence.

Termination Policy

Defines separation processes subject to contract and applicable law.

Exit Interview Policy

Defines exit feedback collection and analysis.

Full & Final Settlement Policy

Defines salary, leave encashment, recoveries, benefits and settlement documentation.

Asset Recovery & Access Deactivation

Ensures company assets are returned and system access is removed at separation.

Relieving & Experience Letter Policy

Defines issuance of applicable employment/separation documents.

11. Legal & Statutory Compliance Framework

Corporate Compliance

Maintain applicable Companies Act, MCA, tax, accounting and statutory records/filings.

Employment & Labour Compliance

Assess and maintain applicable employment, wage, working-time, leave and establishment requirements.

Social Security Compliance

Assess applicability of PF, ESI, gratuity, professional tax, labour welfare fund and related obligations.

POSH Compliance

Where applicable, maintain the required Internal Committee, policy, awareness and complaint/redressal framework.

Tax & Payroll Compliance

Maintain applicable TDS/payroll tax deductions, deposits and employee tax documentation.

Data Protection Compliance

Implement privacy/data-security controls appropriate to the personal data handled by the organization.

12. HR Governance & Policy Administration

Employee Handbook

Central reference document containing employee-facing policies, procedures and expectations.

Policy Acknowledgement

Employees acknowledge receipt/understanding of applicable policies through a controlled process.

Policy Exception Process

Exceptions require documented approval from the designated authority.

Policy Review & Version Control

Each policy should have an owner, version, effective date and review date.

Compliance Calendar

Maintain requirement, applicability, frequency, due date, owner, evidence and status.

Document & Record Control

Store policies and supporting records securely with controlled access and retention.

Suggested Policy Document Format

Every detailed policy should ideally contain: Purpose | Scope | Definitions | Policy Rules | Eligibility | Roles & Responsibilities | Approval Process | Exceptions | Records/Documentation | Confidentiality | Non-compliance/Disciplinary Action | Effective Date | Version | Policy Owner | Review Date.

Recommended implementation order

Phase 1 – Foundation: Appointment, Code of Conduct, Leave & Attendance, POSH, Information Security, Confidentiality, Payroll, Grievance, Disciplinary and Exit.

Phase 2 – Growth: Recruitment, Onboarding, PMS, Compensation, Travel & Expense, Referral, Learning & Development, Remote Work and Employee Benefits.

Phase 3 – Scale: Delegation of Authority, Procurement, Vendor Management, Succession Planning, Data Governance, advanced security and other function-specific policies.